CORE FALSE BELIEF #3 · MY WORTH

“I am not lovable.”

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Where it often comes from

This belief often grows out of love that was missing, inconsistent, or conditional. A parent who was cold, absent, harsh, or only affectionate when we behaved well can leave the impression that we are hard to love. Rejection by a spouse, friends, or a church can deepen it. People who hold this belief often keep others at a distance or try very hard to earn affection, and both can make relationships feel even less safe.

What Scripture teaches

The Bible teaches that God’s love does not begin with our lovableness. He showed His love by sending His Son while we were still far from Him. Paul was convinced that nothing in all creation can separate us from the love of God in Christ Jesus. Zephaniah pictures God rejoicing over His people with singing. God does not love you because you finally became lovable; His love is what makes you beloved. People may fail to love you well, but their failure does not define your lovability.

> *“For I am convinced that neither death nor life, neither angels nor principalities, neither the present nor the future, nor any powers, neither height nor depth, nor anything else in all creation, will be able to separate us from the love of God that is in Christ Jesus our Lord”* (Romans 8:38–39).

Also see

> “This is how God’s love was revealed among us: God sent His one and only Son into the world, so that we might live through Him. And love consists in this: not that we loved God, but that He loved us and sent His Son as the atoning sacrifice for our sins” (1 John 4:9–10).

> “The LORD your God is among you; He is mighty to save. He will rejoice over you with gladness; He will quiet you with His love; He will rejoice over you with singing” (Zephaniah 3:17).

> “So that Christ may dwell in your hearts through faith. Then you, being rooted and grounded in love, will have power, together with all the saints, to comprehend the length and width and height and depth of the love of Christ, and to know this love that surpasses knowledge, that you may be filled with all the fullness of God” (Ephesians 3:17–19).

> “Though my father and mother forsake me, the LORD will receive me” (Psalm 27:10).

Common self-statements

- If people really knew me, they would not love me.
- I am too much, or not enough, to be loved.
- Love always runs out for me.
- I have to earn every bit of affection.
- People only put up with me.
- Even God must find me hard to love.

Common logical errors

- Overgeneralization: Deciding that because some people did not love me well, no one can.

- Personalization: Assuming others' failure to love me is proof that something in me is unlovable.
- Mind reading: Believing I know that people secretly dislike me.
- Discounting the positive: Brushing aside kindness as pity or politeness.

Challenging questions

- Whose love was missing or conditional when I was growing up?
- Does someone else's failure to love me prove I am unlovable?
- What evidence is there that people have cared about me?
- Did God wait for me to become lovable before He loved me?
- How might I be pushing love away to protect myself?
- What would it look like to receive love without earning it?

Truth summary

> Some people did not love me well, and that hurt. But their failure is not a verdict on me. God loved me before I did anything to deserve it, and nothing can separate me from His love in Christ. I am loved, and I can learn to receive love from God and from others.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Love, By God
- God, All Loving
- Loneliness
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Friendship

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Love
- Self-Esteem, Low

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Good Good Father — Chris Tomlin
God's fatherly love is deeper than human approval or achievement.

The God Who Stays — Matthew West
God's faithful presence challenges the expectation of rejection and abandonment.

Love Take Me Over — Steven Curtis Chapman
Receiving God's love can shape loving action instead of fear or performance.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I am not lovable"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I am not lovable." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Where was love missing or conditional for me?
- ☐ Does someone's failure to love me prove I am unlovable?
- ☐ What evidence shows people have cared about me?
- ☐ Did God wait for me to be lovable?
- ☐ How might I push love away?
- ☐ What would receiving love look like?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Nothing can separate me from God's love.
- ☐ God loved me first.
- ☐ Others' failures to love me do not define me.
- ☐ I do not have to earn love.
- ☐ God rejoices over me.
- ☐ I can let safe people care about me.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Romans 8:38–39

  "For I am convinced that neither death nor life, neither angels nor principalities, neither the present nor the future, nor any powers, neither height nor depth, nor anything else in all creation, will be able to separate us from the love of God that is in Christ Jesus our Lord."

- ☐ 1 John 4:9–10

  "This is how God's love was revealed among us: God sent His one and only Son into the world, so that we might live through Him. And love consists in this: not that we loved God, but that He loved us and sent His Son as the atoning sacrifice for our sins."

- ☐ Zephaniah 3:17

  "The LORD your God is among you; He is mighty to save. He will rejoice over you with gladness; He will quiet you with His love; He will rejoice over you with singing."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Love I noticed today: Each evening, write one way God or another person showed care for you, even something small. Note how you responded.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Romans 8:38–39 becomes: "Linda can write: "Nothing in all creation can separate me from God's love in Christ, not even my worst days.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Love, By God" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone.

- ☐ Make a "loved by God" list. Write down every verse on this card that speaks of God's love. Read one aloud each morning.
- ☐ Receive one kindness. When someone is kind to you this week, do not deflect it. Thank them and let it land.
- ☐ Reach out once. Contact one safe person you have been keeping at a distance and suggest coffee, a call, or a walk.
- ☐ Notice the old voice. When you think "I'm unlovable," ask whose voice that sounds like, and answer it with Romans 8:38–39.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie “I am not lovable”: _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A time I let myself be loved
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I am not lovable.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have believed I am too broken or too much to be loved. Thank You that You loved me first and that nothing can separate me from Your love. Heal the places where love was missing, and help me receive Your love and the love of the people You place in my life. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.